A Good-Bye Song

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A Good-Bye Song

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Summary

Castaspella, a pretty famous singer on the verge of losing her contract, finds herself unable to compose her new song after her partner, Shadow Weaver, breaks up with her.

However, an unexpected encounter with Madame Razz and Angella, good friends of her, might be just what she needs…

Notes

I… had a pretty weird break up recently.
My partner of almost two years decided to dump me, for no apparent reason other than having detached from a lot of things, including me.

So, well, I decided to process this the only way I know: writing.

But it was only thanks to a conversation with two new friends from a discord server, Katrien and Evie, that I finally managed to recover the inspiration to write, among other things, this little one-shot.

I know the last thing anyone would like to read is their OTP breaking up, but… I'll still throw this out there. After all, it may resonate with someone, specially if they have ever gone through break up.

See the end of the work for more notes

—There is… no easy way of telling you this, no way I can say it without hurting you, but I have to.

—A-alright?— Castaspella nodded, as they sat in front of each other in her living-room, each with a drink in hand.

She felt her hands shake a bit, hesitant and anxious.

Scared.

—I believe there are aspects of our relationship where things are unfair to you, and we should remain as friends, if that's… alright with you— Shadow Weaver finally explained.

—Unfair?

—Relationships are a two-way road. I should put just as much effort into this as you do, but I haven't.

—Bea, I…

—Allow me to finish— she interrupted, raising a hand. —This is how I am, and you deserve far better. You've been really important to me, made a huge impact on my life, and I have not repaid you in kind. However, I still appreciate you and would feel grateful if you could remain my friend, at the very least.

—You… always said you don't do *friends*— Castaspella reminded her, looking away.

—I'd make an exception for you. As I said, this relationship is unfair to you, but I wouldn't want you to completely leave my life.

—I don't think anything is unfair to me! I-I would rather give you the chance to try and-and put more effort, even if a bit, until you feel it's enough to match mine!— she assured her, fighting the tightness in her chest. —I believe you're what's best for me, I don't need "better", Bea— she insisted. However, she then thought better about it, and added —But, of course, I wouldn't force you to stay in this relationship with me if you don't want to. Just… don't think about what's fair or not; if you want to be with me, then forget about all of that. If you no longer… feel what you used to, then I'll… understand.

Shadow Weaver sighed and looked away too, unable to meet Castaspella's teary gaze.

—This isn't working for me. I have… detached from a lot of things as of late, and you happen to be one of them.

—I see…— she muttered, looking down now. —I- Just know that I'll always be here for you, Bea, alright? And I'd be more than glad to remain as your friend.

—And I greatly appreciate it, Es.

A tense silence followed as she looked away, feeling ashamed and wanting to cry, while Shadow Weaver tried her best to remain composed.

Unable to bear it much more, Castaspella willed herself to face her again and forced a smile as she asked —Why-why don't you tell me about the important decision regarding the Studio that had you so restless the other day?

—Ah, yes. I almost forgot… I made up my mind: I'll be giving up the ownership. I would rather stay as part of the directive body only and delegate the most critical duties to someone who's more… *interested*.

—Interested…

—Someone who will put in the time and effort the Studio deserves…

—Of course… And who would that be?

—I've been considering a few candidates…— the woman admitted, looking away, pensive. —There's that young editor we ascended a few months ago, remember?

—Ah, yes, yes…

—Unless, of course, *you* want it?

—The-the Studio!?

—Yes.

—I- Bea, I…

—No pressure, of course.

—No, no. I would *love to*! A-and if you even want it back, you just have to ask— Castaspella assured her. —I know how important it is for you.

—Trust me… I have the feeling Mystacor Records is more important to you, at this point.

She chuckled and Shadow Weaver rested back on her seat.

For a long while, the women chatted about trivial things, until an alarm made them realize how late it was.

Their farewell was tense; they seemed unable to figure out how to say goodbye like friends instead of lovers, so they settled for shaking hands and Shadow Weaver finally left Castaspella's apartment.

Everything became dull for the young woman.

A few days passed since that night, but she barely registered them. For her, it was as if their farewell just happened.

For Shadow Weaver, it seemed like *nothing* had ever happened between them.

So, as days passed, everything *remained dull*.

Not because “nothing brought her joy”, but rather because, no matter how joyful she felt, she couldn’t *enjoy* the moment.

Plenty of things made her laugh, many more made her smile…

But whenever she was alone, in silence, the memory of that conversation would return to haunt her.

Everything had become dull, because everything felt the same, or eventually led to the same melancholy.

That way, before she knew it… almost a week had passed, and she had achieved close to nothing, duty-wise.

Saying it was frustrating was an understatement.

It made Castaspella want to cry, yell, break something.

She felt enraged, but also sorrowful and weak.

And most importantly, she felt alone…

She knew she wasn’t. She still had her friends and family.

But why, she felt so alone…

That weekend, she found herself in her favourite coffeehouse, sitting outside under the sun.

—Goodness, I don’t know what the fuck I’m doing…— she sighed, resting back on her chair. —I can’t do it. I just *cannot* do it…— she muttered, brushing her hands down her face. — Why is it so difficult!?— she groaned, actually wanting to cry.

Castaspella had no idea what she was doing, what she wanted to do, or how…

She was having a coffee, yes, while attempting to compose her new song, yes.

But she was absolutely not managing either.

Her coffee had gone cold half an hour before…

Her sheet of paper remained empty…

And the pain she was feeling hadn't subsided in the slightest.

She had been told she had to go outside, change the air, and maybe that would help her… *but it wasn't helping*!

Hating herself, hating pretty much everything, Castaspella mustered the courage to ask the waitress to reheat her coffee, and hunched over the table *trying* to start writing.

—Oh! Hello, Deary!— a voice suddenly exclaimed, startling her.

—What- Oh, Madame Razz!— she happily let out, standing up to greet her. —I didn't expect to run into you here!

—Ah, of course, Deary! We're always *just* where we're supposed to be!— she replied, cheerful.

—I see— Castaspella chuckled. —Would you like to join me for a cup of coffee or tea? I can invite you to a piece of pie, maybe.

—Uh! Pie sounds wonderful!— she immediately replied, face lighting up.

—Then please, by all means, take a seat. I'll order the pie.

—Ah, thank you, Deary.

When she returned to the table, Madame Razz was looking at her blank piece of paper; it made her swallow hard as she looked for an excuse… or a way to deflect.

—So, what brings you here today, Razz?

—I was just walking around the block, Deary. It's a beautiful day, isn't it?

It was, in fact, a beautiful sunny morning.

But Castaspella hadn't noticed either the comfortable breeze, the singing of the birds, or the warmth of the sun on her skin.

—You're right. I hadn't realized…

—Are you alright, Esmeralda, Deary?

—Ye-yes, I am!

—Something tells me you need to talk— she insisted. Then, pointing at the sheet of paper, she added —Maybe speaking will lead to some nice composition, don't you think, Deary?

Castaspella chuckled, both amused and moved, and nodded.

Before she could reply, the pie she had ordered and her reheated coffee were brought, so she waited until the waitress left before speaking up.

—I hope you like it, Razz— she first said. —And… I guess I'll take the offer, yes— she accepted, with a sad smile.

—Then go ahead, Deary. Tell this old nurse what worries you.

—I haven't told many yet but… Beatrix broke up with me at the beginning of the week… We-we're still friends and little has changed in our dynamic, but it feels like *everything* has changed overall, if I'm completely honest. So, I'm not sure what to say besides that.

—Oh, I see— Madame Razz replied, brow furrowed in concern. —Now, then, why don't you let me guide the conversation?

—That- Yes, that would be appreciated.

—Madame Razz will help you, Esmeralda, Deary, worry not!

—Thank you— Castaspella chuckled.

—Then, let's see: Did something happen between you two? How did it happen?

—That's the thing, *I'm not sure*. It was really sudden… Nothing happened between us, she just… said she needed to talk to me last Monday, so we met later that day, and she simply *said it*. She spoke about it being unfair to me because she wasn't putting enough effort into our relationship and, well, I told her I didn't mind, that we could still work it out. I said I'd give her a chance to fix that, if so she wanted… And that's when she admitted she's been detaching from a lot of things lately, including me, and… I wouldn't force her to stay with me if she no longer feels the way she used to— Castaspella thoroughly explained. —But nothing "bad" happened, nothing that explains how it happened…

—Oh, Deary… And how did you feel?

—I- Being honest, I kind of expected the conversation to be about that. Not for any reason in particular, I just had a feeling… But I wasn't anxious or afraid of the conversation happening, I even forgot about it until we met, so… I don't know why but I felt *so* hurt. I wasn't expecting this to affect me so much— she admitted, looking away.

—I see… It sounds like you cared more about her than you thought. Isn't that right, Deary?

—I suppose. I didn't realize it before, but I loved- love her more than I imagined, yes. I don't think I can… *stop* loving her.

—And you don't have to, Deary— Razz assured her. —Have you told her how much she means to you?

—Of course. A-and she knows; I told her I'll still be here for her, for whatever she needs— Castaspella nodded. —I mean, we're still… friends. We talk usually, keep working together, help each other out… I just- Well, it's all mostly the same but now I have to be careful not to use endearment terms, and have to remind myself to stay outside her personal space.

Madame Razz listened to her attentively while chewing a piece of her pie, and gave her an apologetic smile. She was considering what to say when a familiar voice chimed in.

—Oh, Casta, Razz! What a coincidence!

—Angella!— Castaspella noticed, standing up to greet her sister-in-law. —Did you come for breakfast?

—Ah, yes. May I join you two?

—Of course! We were just… talking— she accepted.

—I… didn't mean to eavesdrop but I happened to hear part of your conversation, yes.

—Oh…— Castaspella sighed, blushing.

—If I may… I think that's a lot to handle while still being close, Casta— Angella commented. —Don't you think you… maybe need some time or some distance to reorient yourself with the changes in the nature of your relationship?

—Perhaps— she admitted, wrapping her hands around her cup of coffee. —I don't fully grasp the implications of not being partners anymore… not yet.

—I agree with her, Deary— Razz seconded. Their conversation was briefly interrupted by the waitress taking Angella's order, but as soon as she was gone, the woman continued —Love relationships are really hard, are they not? And when they turn out not to work, having to change the way you speak to her… I can only imagine how you're feeling with that, Deary. Do you want to tell us?

As they both looked at her, expecting, Castaspella took a long sip of coffee, searching for the right words.

—I'm… confused. It's bittersweet, I'd say.

—Ah, confused is something— Razz replied, nodding in understanding. —It's a *new* situation, for both of you, to deal with. It's very normal to feel like that, Deary…

—I think… maybe you just need time to be able to process what happened and what it means for you both and your relationship— Angella said. —If she didn't tell you what exactly happened that changed her feelings, and nothing changed for you, *this change* is far harder to deal with.

Castaspella nodded, her head hanging low.

—Do you feel anything else, Deary? I imagine some mixed feelings?

—Yes. For me, nothing changed, indeed, and I want to understand what she means, but I can't fully comprehend it— she admitted. —I feel… like numbness. I mean, it's the first time I have a break-up…— she sighed. —Every time I remember… I'm overwhelmed by intense

sorrow and cry so much… It's like everything is normal, but then I remember. I seem fine until, out of the blue, the memory of her returns, and I suddenly break down.

Right that moment, as Angella's croissant and tea arrived, she exchanged a glance with Madame Razz and waited for the waitress to leave again before giving her opinion.

—This is probably the last thing you want to hear, but… it will truly hurt for a long time— she began. Looking down at her tea and absentmindedly stirring it with the spoon, she went on —However, it *will* pass eventually. It will get better. Very slowly, little by little you'll stop remembering as much and start feeling neutral about it. It just takes *time*, Casta.

—It… makes sense, yes.

—You seem to have hardened yourself, and I completely understand, but you need to let yourself feel it, alright?— Angella added, while Razz kept eating, occasionally nodding. —Do some… self-care. Focus on yourself, on what *you* need. You could maybe journal if you like, to let it all out. Or, well, you're a composer and a singer, music is probably your best option to do that; scream lyrics that resonate with what you're feeling, or write your own— she suggested.

—Yeah, that's the only way I know to sublimate my feelings— she admitted with half a smirk. —I've been trying to compose this new song, and I considered making it about this, but… I find myself unable to write a single word— Castaspella explained.

—You know, Deary?— Razz called her, having finished her pie. —Forgetting is a kind of coping mechanism. You probably do it to feel better. But that's also a way to avoid it, which may work for a short while, yet it's definitely not a permanent solution, Esmeralda, Deary.

—But you don't have to force it— Angella clarified. —Maybe it's not the time yet, so it's alright to avoid the matter until you're ready to face it.

—I know, yes. I'll just… do it if I manage to write something again at some point— Castaspella nodded with a faint smile. —But it's kind of frustrating being so inspiration-less lately.

—It can certainly be— she nodded. —As a novelist, I sometimes go through the same; it happened just a month ago. I was so furious because I couldn't get myself to write anything… But it came back to me eventually. Inspiration is just… a bit of a mess sometimes.

—Absolutely— Castaspella nodded.

—Well, another thing you can do is, maybe, hug someone. It gives you dopamine— Angella suggested with a smile.

—I… just realized I haven't hugged anyone in a really long time.

—Oh, goodness. Well, I wouldn't mind hugging you, and I'm certain that Micah would be more than glad to hug you tightly for as long as you need.

—Thank you— Castaspella chuckled.

—I can give you a little tip to process your emotions when they come up, Deary. Every time you remember, write down what you feel, why you feel it, what you miss, and a good memory— Madame Razz proposed, while Angella proceeded to eat her breakfast. —It can be some words, or a few sentences; make it however you feel like doing it. And after that, try to warm your heart with some good memories. When you feel like it, you can do something else you enjoy, like singing or composing!

—Of course, I can do that.

—Can you tell us a good memory you have with her, Esmeralda, Deary?

Castaspella had to think for a moment, so Razz and Angella silently gave her some time.

She had been so buried in sorrow that she had almost forgotten all the happy times spent together.

—Yes, I… suppose a really nice memory with her is from my last birthday— she eventually managed to say. With a faint smile, she recalled —She invited me to an empty room in the Studio, right around midnight, and played the happy-birthday song for me on the guitar…

—Oh, Deary, that sounds very sweet!— Razz cheerfully commented. —Does the memory bring up any emotions?

—It does… I can recall it perfectly well; how heartwarming it was… Still is.

—Good, that's good— she nodded. —Hold on to that feeling.

As Castaspella looked down at her empty sheet of paper, despite her smile, the women realized what she was thinking.

—For now, just don't punish yourself for being unable to compose— Angella comforted her. —I guess what I mean is: be kind to yourself; let yourself process what's going on. It *will* be alright— she assured her. —And yes, inspiration to write *anything* can be a real pain, but it will come back around. So, if anything excites you, whatever burst of inspiration you get, *grasp it*. Even if it's not a song you're working on, even if it's not a composition you can, or *want* to present for your next release to keep your contract and all… just follow that.

—You know about the contract…

—Micah mentioned it, yes.

—Thank you, Angella. That's really good advice— Castaspella sighed.

—Why don't you tell us another nice memory, Deary?— Razz then proposed.

—I mean… my memory isn't that good, to be honest— she admitted, looking away with a faint blush. —But I could tell you about our musical collaborations. We'd… banter a lot, but I really enjoyed that. She could be a real bitch, I won't lie, but it was so much fun to rebuke

and pretty much compete to see who would give up first— she laughed. —It filled me with joy when she recognized I could be wittier than she imagined, or when she'd stare in shock at my boldness— she added. —She always said she liked that of me… And I-I certainly miss her kisses. For someone who behaves so coldly, they could be so warm and soft.

—That sounds like a lot, Esmeralda, Deary— Razz first replied, surprised. Her expression then changed and she smiled as she added —But it also sounds like you had a lot of fun!

—Yes— she admitted, melancholic.

—Perhaps you can repeat that. Playing music together, recording songs together… Just relaxed, chatting friendly, wouldn't that be something you want?

—I- Yes, certainly.

—Then why don't you ask her!? Being just friends now doesn't mean you can't still be close and do things together— the woman argued.

—I suppose I could.

—It's different for each person, Deary, and you should find out what works for you two. But remember: it will only be as awkward as you make it. If you treat it like something normal she's likely to follow, Deary.

—But, I would say that, if you need time, that's alright too— Angella chimed in.

—Definitely— Razz agreed.

—If it's not something you can handle yet, or something you want to do, then you don't have to do it right away, okay?

—I hadn't thought about it, Angella— she admitted. —I suppose… a part of me wants to take some time, but another doesn't want to— she explained. Then, she sighed —It's just so difficult to explain.

—Maybe just distance yourself a bit and see how it feels, Casta. You don't have to go no contact if you don't want to.

—Especially if she still cares about you— Razz pointed out.

—And, of course, don't feel like you have to take our advice, alright? It's completely up to you and what you want to do. You know the situation best.

—I welcome all and any advice, Angella. I've been seriously at a loss all week— Castaspella replied, shaking her head slightly.

—That's absolutely valid, I get what you mean. And I think trying to figure out what's going to help you is for the best. I mean, even if you gave us all the details, we wouldn't know.

—Oh, she definitely didn't give us every detail. That's impossible— Razz remarked.

—I know, I know. What I mean is that, even if she did, we still wouldn't understand the situation completely— Angella clarified. She then looked at Castaspella again to suggest — I'd say, if you feel like you might need distance, then try it. Nothing is permanent, alright? You can always get close again once you've gotten over this.

—That's true.

—Yes, but be careful with that. Getting close again is more difficult than taking distance— Razz warned her.

—It is, but sometimes, distance is necessary.

—That much is true, but I like to say that it's not for everyone. We all feel different about it and handle it differently. It's valid to take distance, but it might not feel good for everyone.

Castaspella chuckled at their little discussion and the women looked back at her again, dropping the matter.

—We understand you being at a loss, Deary. But I hope the conversation helped a bit— she gently told her.

—It absolutely did, thank you both very much— Castaspella smiled.

—Of course, Esmeralda, Deary! You're very welcome!— Razz smiled. —I will always be here if you want to talk, even if you don't know what to say, or how to say it— she assured her.

—Indeed. It was no problem, Casta. I hope you feel a bit better now— Angella nodded. — And if you ever need anything, just reach out.

—Thank you— she repeated, now on the verge of tears.

—You're most welcome, Deary.

With that, their conversation came to an end and they paid for the bill before saying goodbye. They both gave Castaspella a tight hug, reassured her one last time, and finally departed.

The day went on for her, and still, not one word could be written.

However, as she went through the conversation over and over again, she managed to relax just enough to go to sleep without crying like every other night.

And when she woke up the following day, inspiration struck.

She had a melody in her head, one that made her cry but felt comforting at the same time. As she wrote it down, she could feel it slowly release her feelings, as if her heart, filled to the brim with pain and sorrow, slowly drained.

That way, with the melody stuck in her head, by the time night fell, words finally managed to form, and it didn't take long for a song to be drafted.

Days later, when her new composition was due, she presented her melancholic piece.

She knew it would raise questions, but she wasn't obligated to answer them.

So, when it was released, and the inquiries began, Castaspella only smiled and answered — I'm a human being too. I hurt like anyone, and I believe this song can resonate with many who might be hurting too.

And her statement did, in fact, turn out to be true…

After all, who hasn't been hurt at some point?

This is a good-bye song

For the one who is now gone.

The feelings I couldn't appreciate

Have now surfaced with strength,

And beyond my power is to just forget.

So may my heart never regret

The time spent, the words said,

The deep feelings it has felt.

This is a good-bye song

For a chapter now closed.

What could have been,

For what never will,

My heart may never cease to sing.

So I will go on my way now,

I will dance to this bitter sound,

Until this pain I no longer bout.

End Notes

Well, I don't know whether to say "I hope you enjoyed this" or "sorry for the angst", but I certainly hope it was somewhat of a good read.

Again, I must thank Katrien and Evie. The convo between Casta, Razz, and Angella is, paraphrasing, what they two told me.

And, for anyone who related to this in any way: As Evie told me, it will pass with time.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!